

WEEK 5: Elements of Writing

Using Language Accurately in Academic Writing

Video 1: Accuracy in Academic Writing

What Is Accuracy? Why Is It Important?

- Being correct in terms of grammar, vocabulary, and following style guidelines
- Conveying ideas or information properly
- Lack of accuracy results in wrong inference and reduced engagement with your text



Common Problems

- **Grammar**

- Wrong verb forms
- Missing article
- Singular or plural use
- Agreement error
- Wrong article

- **Sentence Structure**

- Missing apostrophe
- Incomplete sentences
- Clumsy and overly long sentences

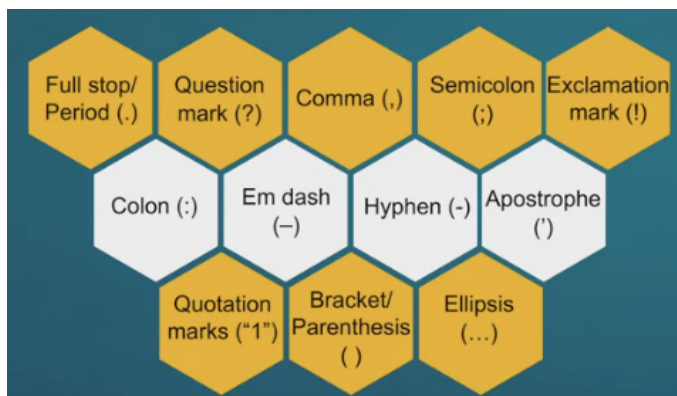
- **Word Use**

- Wrong word
- Spelling errors
- Wrong form

Writing Process

- **Prep stage**
 - Choose your topic.
 - Gather ideas on your topic.
 - Organize your ideas on your topic.
- **Draft stage**
 - Write your essay/paper/assignment.
- **Review stage**
 - Review your content and structure.
 - Check your work for accuracy.
- **Revise stage**
 - Revise your content and structure.
 - Proofread your text.
 - Make final corrections accordingly.

Video 2: Using Punctuations Commonly Used Punctuation Marks



Apostrophe (')

- Contractions
He is VS. He's

- Possessives

My mother's
Students'
it's vs. its

Semicolon (;)

- Linking two connected phrases
Between comma and full stop
For Citation

Example: Rima cited only relevant studies; her presentation was focused.

Colon (:)

- Introducing explanations
I have canceled the class: I am down with a fever.
- Starting a list
Two people were selected: Sam and Azad
- Introducing a quote
He ended with the words of Freire: "Education is an act of love.'
- Emphasis
He wanted to study in O one place: The University of Edinburgh.

Comma (,)

- Separating independent clauses when separated by coordinating conjunctions: but, yet, so, etc.
Ex.-I did not have any food, but the dog refused to leave.
- After introductory clauses, starting with while, if, though, since, etc.
Ex-If you heat iron, it expands.
- Commas to separate words and phrases
I have left a shirt, an umbrella, and a book in the bus.

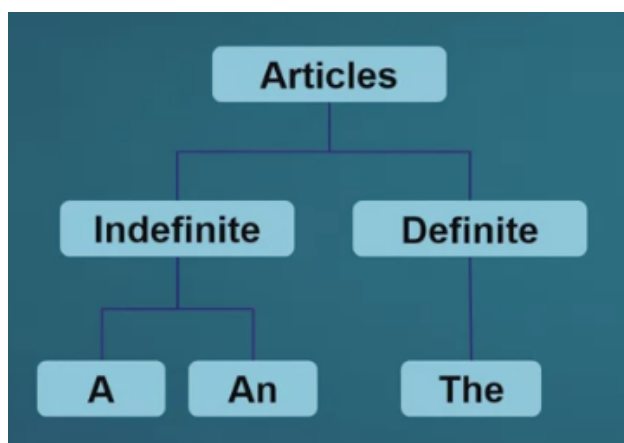
Inverted commas or Quotation marks ("..."/'...')

- Emphasizing a word
The word **weird** is difficult to define.
- Quoting an author
According to Freire (1978), 'Education is an act of love.'
- Double quotation marks to indicate quotes within quotes
'Education is an "act" of love.' (UK Style)
"Education is an 'act' of love." (US Style)

Strategies for Mastering Punctuation Use

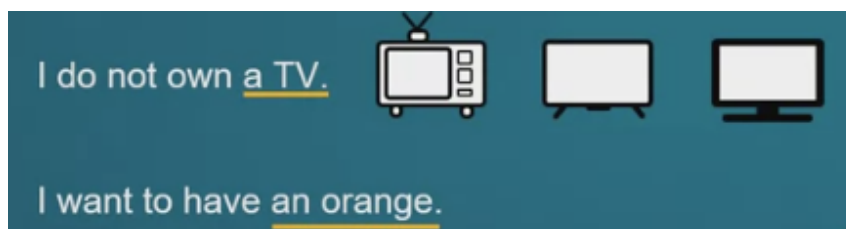
- Notice punctuation use
Reading academic texts
- Know explicit rules from reliable sources
Purdue OWL
Grammarly
Oxford/Cambridge/McMillan/Collins dictionaries
- Edit and proofread after writing
- Develop awareness
Common punctuation mistakes or errors

Video 3: Using Articles



Indefinite Article: A/An

- Used with singular countable nouns that are not specific



- Consonant **sounds** - 'a'
- Vowel **sounds** - 'an'
a university
an honor

Video subtitle - "Most of people generally confuse sound with letter. So whenever you are using a, you use it before a consonant sound. Whereas when you use an it's always before a vowel sound."

Example:

I saw **a car** parked on the left side of the road. **The car** started moving toward my department.

Video subtitle- "The next one is whenever you use A or An, it becomes the when you are referring to the same object second time. For example, if you have a sentence like this, a couple of sentences here, I saw a car parked on the left side of the road. The car started moving towards my department. So when you say that first time when I look at a car, I say I saw a car parked on the left side of the road. But when I'm referring to the same car second time, in the next sentence, I'm using the car. So a car becomes the car after we are familiar with the car, we have already mentioned it once. In the second mention we make it the car."

Definite Article: The

- Used only before specific nouns
 - Singular and plural nouns
 - Countable and uncountable nouns

Ex- **The book** you asked me to read was amazing.
The books displayed in the library lounge are quite useful.
The information you shared with me was invaluable.

- When there is just one
 - The moon
 - The president of Japan
- Superlatives
 - The tallest building
 - The fastest animal
 - The greatest batsman
 - The greatest goalkeeper
- Already been mentioned at least once
- Referring to a category
 - The tiger (Tigers are) is a dangerous animal(s)

Video subtitle - "So, already, when something is already mentioned then you can also use The, we have already talked about. Next, when you refer to a category, you can also use The before the category. For example, instead of saying tigers are dangerous animals, you can say the tiger is a dangerous animal."

- Regions/rivers
- Musical instruments
- Institutions or bodies

Services

Strategies for Mastering Article Use

- Notice article use in academic texts
- Know the rules explicitly
- Complete tasks on article use
- Edit and proofread
- Make a list of common mistakes or errors in article use

Video 4: Tense Forms

Tenses in Academic Writing

- Most commonly used tenses in academic writing

Simple present

Simple past

Present perfect

- Other tenses can also be used

Simple Present

Functions	Examples
State the objective or present an argument	This study analyzes the impact of social media on undergraduate students from Andhra Pradesh, India. (objective)
Generalize or comment on the findings of the previous or current study	Many studies report that IITs make several impactful scientific inventions. The study identifies that cortisol secretion is impacted by mental stress.
Refer to tables or figures	Figure 1.1 presents the overview of the study.

Simple Past

Functions	Examples
Report the findings of the previous studies or the current study	Spencer (2008) reported the gendered language use in workplace email communication.
Describe your methodology for approach, data, and research tools	Five hundred students participated in the online survey.
Used after past-time markers	After 2000, Indian companies had to stop the purchase of typewriters.

Present Perfect

Functions	Examples
Introduce recent research trends • Continuing research interest in the field • Present research from the past to present	After the Paris Agreement, there has been renewed interest in studying the impact of CO ₂ emissions in developing nations.
Summarize the findings of previous research	Studies have found that 50% of urban households in India depend on municipal water.
Indicate a gap in the research literature	The National Education Policy has emphasized the need to encourage bilingual practices in schools.

Paraphrasing Academic Texts

Video 1: Purpose of Paraphrasing Academic Texts

Purpose of Paraphrasing

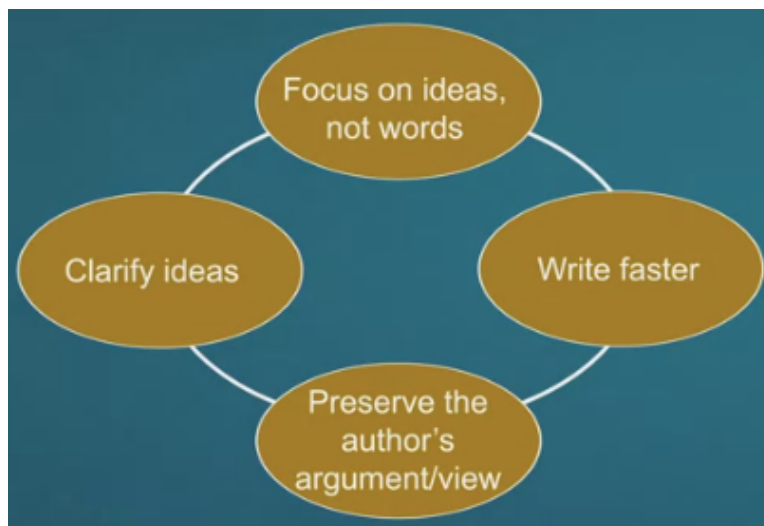
- Avoiding **plagiarism**
Not copying information from direct sources
- **Synthesizing information from other's work**
Essential for academic writing
- Building a credible argument or analysis

Effective Paraphrasing Improves Credibility

Source: Experience in Peru, Bolivia, South Africa, and Paraguay, all of which saw dramatic **new multilingual language policies** in those years (see below), convinced me that in an **ecology of languages** where indigenous languages and speakers have been marginalized for centuries in **post-colonial contexts**, **bilingual intercultural education** can become a vehicle for **promoting language equality, language rights, and biliteracy**. (Hornberger, 2022)

According to Hornberger (2022), education involving exposure to an array of cultures in two languages as part of the latest **multilingual approach** to policy-making can be adopted to promote **linguistic equality** and **rights and literacy in colonized countries** and use **multiple languages**.

Why Paraphrase?



Video 2: Using Synonyms in Paraphrasing

Why Use Synonyms in Paraphrasing?

- To restate the words without distorting the original meaning

Example:

Source: More than half of the **shopkeepers** who **attended the protest rally** have been in the **cement business** for **20 years**.

Paraphrase: The majority of the **retailers** who **participated in the dissent event** were in the **construction material business** for **two decades**.

Synonyms for Paraphrasing

- Change nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, and transition signals in the source texts.

Example:

Source: In the beginning, the framers of the Indian Constitution had disagreements on many aspects of the Constitution.

Paraphrase: Initially, Indian Constitution designers differed on multiple features of the Constitution.

Does Providing Synonyms Alone Ensure Effective Paraphrasing?

- Effective paraphrasing requires more than changing synonyms.

Example of Effective Paraphrasing

Source: Student activists are fighting against the fees raise in government institutions. If the protest continues for a month, then the government might reconsider the decision.

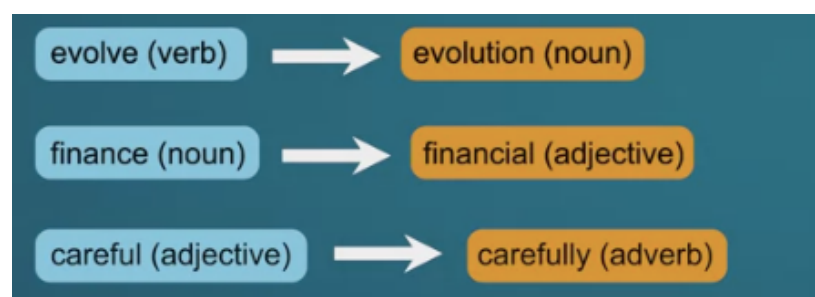
Poor paraphrase: Student leaders are protesting against the fee hike in public institutions. If the demonstration/dharna is prolonged for more days, then the government might review the move.

Better paraphrase: The fee hike in public institutions might be reviewed if student leaders prolong the dharna beyond 30 days.

Video 3: Changing Word Class in Paraphrasing

Changing the Word Class

- Changing some of the words given in the text from one part of speech to another:



- The second stage in paraphrasing after finding synonyms

Strategies for Changing Word Class

- Change a verb to a noun by adding suffixes like -ment, -ance, -ence, -tion, or -sion.

Examples: appointment, performance, election.

- Change a noun to an adjective by adding suffixes like -ly, -al, -able, -ful, -ish, -ary, -y, -less, or -like.

Examples: childish, customary, comfortable.

- Change an adjective to an adverb by adding the suffix -ly.

Examples: probably, gently.

Video 4: Changing Word Order in Paraphrasing

Changing the Word Order

- Changing the order of the words while retaining the idea or the concept
- A major strategy in paraphrasing that helps avoid plagiarism
- May change the emphasis on specific ideas or concepts
- Grammatical accuracy is a prerequisite

Examples of Changing the Word Order

- During the Industrial Revolution, several countries across the continents of Europe and America began transitioning to newer manufacturing processes.
- Several countries in Europe and America transitioned to newer manufacturing processes during the Industrial Revolution.
- The transition to newer manufacturing processes in Europe and America happened during the Industrial Revolution.

In each of these sentences, the emphasis changes from the Industrial Revolution to the countries involved to the newer manufacturing processes.

Using the Passive Voice

- By changing sentences from the active voice to the passive voice.

- Passive structures:
 - is/am/are/was/were + past participle
 - has/have/had been + past participle
 - can/could/will/would/may/might/
 - shall/should + be + past participle

Examples of Using the Passive Voice

Example 1 - "Observe" and "were observed"

- The study observed the changes over the next 14 months.
The changes over the next 14 months were observed.

Example 2 - "recommend" and "is recommended"

- We recommend using an alternative methodology for efficiency.
Using an alternative methodology is recommended for efficiency.

Summarizing Academic Texts

Video 1: Purpose of Summarizing Academic Texts

Summarizing Academic Texts

- Offering a preview of what to expect in the text
 - For example, the summary of an argumentative essay will include:
 - An introduction
 - The central claim
 - The author's purpose
 - The main points that support the argument
 - The significance of the argument
- Citing the original text
- Paraphrasing

Purpose of a Summary

- Provides precise and relevant information
- Saves a lot of time as it is shorter than the original text
- Makes the required information easily accessible and simple
- Leaves out extraneous or unnecessary information
- Allows a person to decide in a short span of time whether to read the entire text
- Demonstrates understanding of the original text
- Helps remember essential information

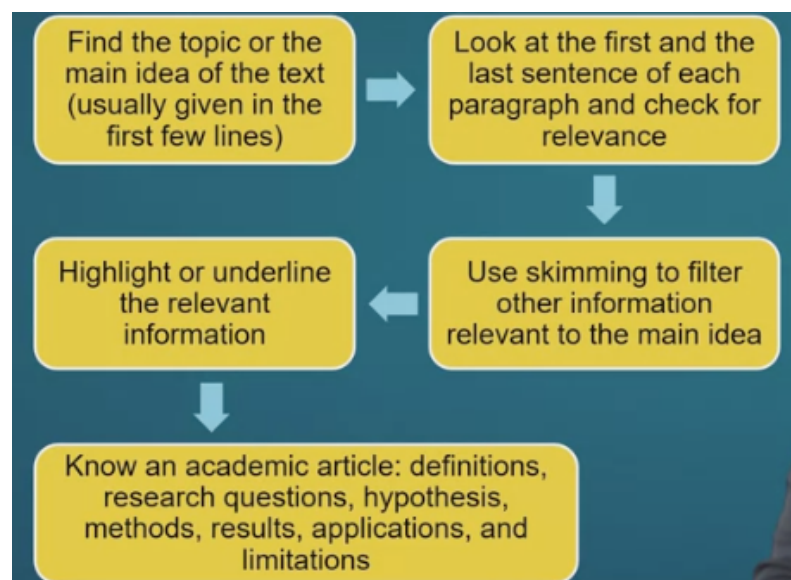
Example

Principally, this study chooses to focus on how neural networks may be used to provide decision support to companies by observing numerous factors that are relevant to their finance, such as stock prices, cash flow, creditworthiness, demographic data, etc. Despite the enormous number of research articles that are published each year in the ever-growing field of artificial intelligence and artificial neural networks, it is possible to observe only a select few that focus on this particular area, i.e., its use in financial decision-making. Furthermore, a number of these studies were conducted over 10 years prior to our study and discussed models that are no longer in productive use in our current day practice.

Summary: This study focuses on the use of artificial neural networks for financial decision-making and, in the process, addresses the lack of research in the area.

Video 2: Identifying Key Points in Academic Texts

Identifying Key Points in Academic Texts



Example

You may have wondered how waves, such as voice, music, temperature, etc., that exist in the real world around us are processed by systems such as computers. This is made possible by (digital signal processors DSPs). The analog or continuous waves are taken and first converted into a series of zeros and ones, known as digital signals, by an analog to digital convertor (ADC).

These digital signals are processed by the DSPs, which help perform actions with the signals, such as storing them in memory, sending them to an output device such as a speaker, or even creating a visual display output. Without DSPs, several applications such as sonar, radar, or image and speech processing would be impossible.

How We Did It

- Identify the main idea: the passage is about DSPs
- Identify important points about DSPs by skimming through the passage
- Highlight the key points in the passage

Video 3: Creating a Summary of the Key Points

Creating a Summary of the Key Points

- Arrange the key points in a logical order
- Connect the key points together using conjunctions or linkers as applicable
Examples: so, and, but, then, not only...but also, etc.
- Check for cohesion in the text

Let Us Do It

- Summarizing the key points from the example and arranging them in a logical order:
 - Continuous waves are converted into digital signals by analog to digital convertors (ADCs).
 - Digital signal processors (DSPs) are used to process these digital signals.
 - Applications of DSP include sonar, radar, image, and speech processing.

Using Conjunctions or Linkers

Summary:

Initially, continuous waves are transformed into digital signals by analog to digital convertors (ADCs). **Then**, digital signal processors (DSPs) are employed to process these signals. Such DSPs are essential to applications like sonar, radar, image, and speech processing.

Video subtitle -“Now what we did initially, that's a signpost. We are saying that there is another stage that is there. Then in the next stage because we have used these two signpost to indicate that we are talking about two stages. Then we use the detail, the key points that we highlighted earlier. We are using the key points and keep making the summary. In the process of doing so, we may rephrase certain words wherever it's possible, but there are too many technical words in this case. That's why it's very difficult to find synonyms of these technical words and replace them with something else. It's very difficult as much as you try as far as possible to do this. But if you think that there are no words that can replace these keywords, you can go ahead with the keywords that are there in the original text. There won't be any problem.”

Video 4: Verifying the Accuracy of the Summary

Checklist for Verifying the Accuracy

